Sam Ayres

VP, Director of Technology
hello@5am.dev · Brooklyn, New York

SUMMARY

A full-stack engineer turned technology lead, with a background in healthcare and pharma agency work. Over the past four years I've helped grow a development team, the processes, and the technical foundations that now support multiple brand teams and global pharmaceutical clients.

EXPERIENCE

CultHealth, New York, United States

VP, Director of Technology · *Nov 2024 – Present*

Director of Technology · *Nov 2022 – Oct 2024*

Associate Director of Technology · *Jun 2021 – Oct 2022*

Clients: AbbVie, Axsome, Novo Nordisk, Servier

- Manage a team of 4 direct reports and 2 international development teams across 10+ pharmaceutical and healthcare brands, partnering with project management and account teams on scoping, budgeting, and delivery.
- Led technology across pharma and healthcare brand teams, embedding early in each project to surface risks before they become blockers and keep delivery on track.
- Built and maintained CI/CD pipelines supporting 100+ project deliveries per year, bringing consistency and repeatability to project releases across all brand environments.
- Introduced Kanban workflows and Git branching strategies that improved cross-team collaboration and reduced late-stage merge conflicts.
- Created internal automation tooling for email, banner, and site deployment using Gulp, MJML, and custom APIs — automating manual work across the team.
- Established hiring processes, engineering standards, and code review culture from the ground up as the department scaled.

Heartbeat, New York, United States

Senior Web Developer · *Feb 2020 – May 2021*

Clients: Acadia, Agile Therapeutics

- Delivered compliant digital experiences for pharmaceutical and healthcare brands, working closely with medical, legal, and regulatory teams throughout the review process.
- Developed modular, accessible React single-page applications with optimized state management and improved performance for better user experience.
- Modernized legacy Drupal codebases by transitioning to Symfony microservices, improving maintainability and overall system performance.
- Built and maintained RESTful APIs, GraphQL endpoints, and reusable UI components to enable scalable and maintainable frontend architecture.

Circle Interactive, Bristol, United Kingdom

Web Developer · *Feb 2016 – Jan 2020*

Full-stack development using React and REST APIs, managing CI/CD pipelines & mentoring junior developers.

Cap2 Solutions Ltd

Junior Web Developer · *Sep 2014 – Jan 2016* · Bath, United Kingdom

PHP & JS feature development for a sports management system built with Angular & Symfony.

Nokia Siemens Networks

Junior Software Engineer · *Aug 2012 – Aug 2013* · Bristol, United Kingdom

PHP, JS, and Ruby environment testing using Node.js and Watir.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's in Web Design
University of the West of England
2011 – 2014

RESOURCES

GitHub
LinkedIn

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks

CSS3 · HTML5 · JavaScript · MJML · Node.js · PHP · React · SCSS · Symfony · Webflow

Infrastructure & DevOps

Apache · AWS · GIT · Heroku · NGINX

Database, APIs & Misc

GraphQL · Salesforce · Strapi · SQL · Veeva

CMS & Design

AEM · Drupal · Figma · Photoshop · Storyblok · Webflow · WordPress